

STEP 7 · ROUND 2

Round 2 — Pathfinder Prototype

Round 2 is a team round. The Top 50 from Round 1 team up (3 – 5 members per team) and build a working prototype against the Season 1 brief. Teams and scoring are managed on the HackerEarth platform.

Team up on HackerEarth

- Round 2 opens on Tue, 11 Aug 2026 on the HackerEarth platform.
- Form a team of 3 to 5 members directly on HackerEarth — team invites, joins and roster changes all happen inside the round.
- Every team member must have cleared Round 1 and be on their college's AMPlified roster. Solo entries are not accepted in Round 2.

One score for the whole team

- Round 2 is scored as a team. Every member gets the same score and the same tokens — this round rewards collaboration, not individual points.
- Only one submission per team is evaluated. Nominate a team captain on HackerEarth to manage the final submission.

Only the Top 25 teams present

- Round 2 submissions close on Sun, 30 Aug 2026, followed by a 3-day evaluation window.
- The Top 25 teams are announced on Thu, 3 Sep 2026 and invited to the live judging round on Wed, 9 Sep 2026.
- The Top 3 teams are announced on Fri, 11 Sep 2026. Prizes: MacBook 13", iPad Air M4, iPad A16.

SEASON 1 BRIEF

AI-Powered Personalised Learning Path Recommender

Your Round 2 challenge for Season 1. Read the background carefully — your prototype and pitch will be judged against this brief.

Background

- Online learning platforms offer thousands of courses across diverse domains. While recommendation systems can suggest relevant courses, learners often struggle to identify the right sequence of resources needed to achieve a specific goal.
- Different learners have different skill levels, interests, career aspirations and learning preferences — a one-size-fits-all approach does not work.
- An AI-powered Personalised Learning Path Recommender can bridge this gap by understanding a learner's profile, analysing learning objectives, identifying skill gaps and generating a structured roadmap of courses, projects and assessments tailored to the individual.

Your goal

- Design and build an intelligent learning assistant that recommends personalised learning paths based on a learner's interests, goals, previous learning history and skill level.
- The solution should generate a structured learning roadmap, explain its recommendations, and adapt suggestions based on user feedback and progress.

ROUND 2 · JUDGING

How your prototype is judged

The HCLTech + HackerEarth panel scores every Top-50 submission against these six criteria. Weightages are fixed for Season 1.

Judging criteria & weightage

- Problem Understanding & Solution Design — 20%
- Functionality & Feature Completeness — 25%
- AI / ML Implementation — 20%
- Innovation & Creativity — 15%
- User Experience & Interface — 10%
- Performance & Code Quality — 10%

What moves you up the ranking

- A clear articulation of the learner problem and how your design addresses it end-to-end.
- A working prototype where the core flows actually run — not just mockups.
- Real AI/ML in the loop: profiling, recommendation, adaptation. Explain the models and data you used.
- A polished user experience that a first-time learner can navigate without hand-holding.
- Clean, readable code and a solution that performs on realistic input.

ROUND 2 · SUBMISSIONS

What to submit

Every team must submit all five items on HackerEarth before Sun, 30 Aug 2026, 23:59 IST. Incomplete submissions are not evaluated.

1 · Source code (ZIP)

- Complete source code as a ZIP file with everything needed to run the solution.
- Exclude virtual environments, build artefacts and large dependency folders.
- Include a README with setup and execution instructions.

2 · GitHub repository

- A public (or access-shared) GitHub link containing the same source code.
- Commit history should reflect the development process across the team.

3 · Solution documentation (PDF / PPT)

- Problem understanding, solution approach, system architecture, AI/ML techniques used, key features and workflows, and challenges faced and how you addressed them.

4 · Demo video (3 – 5 minutes)

- Walk through the core functionality and key features. Explain the overall workflow and user experience.

5 · Application access

- Preferred: a deployed application URL the judges can open.
- If not deployed, include clear local setup and execution instructions in the README.